

Consolidation Discovery: Research Plan

Docket Clerks

Consolidation - March 1, 2022

This research will take place during [sprint number] March 9, 2022 - Mar 22, 2022	
Related Story	Other Notes
Story: 3820 Story: 5483 Story: 342 Story: 2379 Story: 3571	Notes for completed interviews to be documented in Google Forms Consolidation context gathering notes

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Overview & Purpose

Background information on why this research is needed

The purpose of this research is to engage with USTC docket clerks to better understand their experiences with consolidation and to identify opportunities for improvement. USTC stakeholders have prioritized 1 Epic with 4 stories at this time which outline the following objectives:

[EPIC] 3820: “Consolidation” of two or more cases

- Understand user workflows and usability concerns related to consolidation of cases

Story 5483: Consolidated Cases: Display on Dashboard

- Inform the workflow, design, and usability of the consolidation dashboard display

Story 342: Consolidation of cases - System automatically suggests

- Determine whether or not automation would improve the user experience and if so, inform the design and usability of the automation

Story 2379: Consolidated: Ability to modify case caption/docket number for an order in a consolidated case

- Understand the context in which the user would need the ability to modify the case caption/docket number for an order in a consolidated case

Story 3571: Court User - QC Edits for Consolidated Cases

- [UX likely not needed] Create consistency by applying edits from one QC across all consolidated cases

Research Goals

Overall aim or vision to outline the purpose of our work

1. **Understand and document the unique perspectives, needs and experiences of Docket Clerks as related to consolidation**
2. **Define key moments in the user’s experiences to identify opportunities to improve the consolidation process**
3. **Create an enhanced user experience across DAWSON’S consolidation process**

Guiding Questions

Overarching “big picture” questions we want to answer through this research

* These questions will not be asked directly to users. Interview guide is outlined below.

- What are users expectations when consolidating cases?
 - What do users need and value?
 - How can we make it easier for users to complete their tasks?
- How does consolidation integrate into a larger workflow?
- How have users done this in the past?
- What challenges and opportunities are there with this process?
 - What areas of the UI impact their experience most?
 - How should we prioritize our improvements?

Research Methods

How we will approach our research to gather the information we need

- 1:1 non-standardized interviews
 - Duration of 45-60 minutes
 - Scheduled remotely via zoom

Engagement Groups

A list of people we will speak with to learn more about their experiences

In order to gather diverse perspectives from people that utilize DAWSON, we will meet with 5-8 users with representation from the following category:

Interviewee Participants	
User Type	Approx. # of participants
Docket Clerk	5-8

Recruitment Email

Email template for scheduling interviews with participants

Subject: Consolidation Feedback Interview

Hi _____

Our team is currently seeking to better understand the processes around consolidation of cases and documents at the U.S. Tax Court and would like to invite you to give your feedback. The purpose of this research is to form a better understanding of your challenges with consolidation and more specifically to identify ways to improve this process. If you are interested, I would like to schedule a 45-60 minute discussion with you via Zoom and get your thoughts and feedback. If you are interested in participating, please schedule a time with me at

<https://calendly.com/flexion-recruiting-ux/ustc-consolidation-user-feedback-session>

Please let me know if none of these times work for you. Thank you, we greatly value your feedback and time!

Regards,
Lia

Interview Guide

Questions we will reference to guide our conversations with users

Slack reminder for team

Post this message in slack 30-60 minutes before an interview.

Hi team! We're about to start another user interview at [ADD TIME] If you'd like to join, please reply in a thread to this post. The first team member to respond gets to join.

A few things to remember:

- You can access the zoom link here: [ADD LINK]
- Only 1 extra team member per interview. We don't want to overwhelm the participant.
- Join on time and stay the whole time. If you can't make the entire interview, we kindly ask you to skip.
- Save questions for the end. Please jot down any questions that come up for you via your personal notes. We will open up the last 5-10 minutes for questions or clarifications.

Intro Script

Hello! My name is _____. I am a UX Researcher working with U.S. Tax Court and I want to thank you for agreeing to spend time with me today. I also have a member of my team on _____ They will be taking notes for me.

As we mentioned in the invitation, Flexion is designing a tool for the U.S. Tax Court to allow Docket Clerks to consolidate cases online. As part of this process, we're gathering feedback from Docket Clerks to help inform our designs. We are interested in learning more about your processes around some specific features.

Participation in this interview is completely voluntary and optional, you can terminate the session at any time for any reason. Your responses are confidential, when the findings are reported they will be aggregated and anonymized so that nothing that is said can be tied directly to you.

Please note that we are performing this research to validate ideas and features of the platform, and we are not testing you as a participant. Feel free to be as open and candid as you would like and don't hold back your opinions. You will not hurt anyone's feelings.

Would it be okay if we record our conversation for note-taking purposes? Your feedback will be kept entirely anonymous and will only be used internally for note-taking purposes.

Does that sound good? Any questions before we get started? [Do not record if screen-sharing PII]

Introduction [approx 20-30 min]

- To start, can you tell us a little about yourself and what you do?
 - What is your current role with the Tax Court?

[screenshare our mig environment and give them mouse control]

- Can you walk me through an example of a consolidated case and how you might handle it?
 - How often do you encounter consolidated cases?
 - How do you interact with consolidated cases?
 - How does it compare to how you interact with cases that are not consolidated?
 - What does a consolidated case look like?

Consolidating Cases

- Describe a time when you were involved in consolidating a case.
 - What are you doing when this happens?
 - What do you need to do?

- How do you know when your work is done?
- Any issues?
- Can you walk me through an example
 - Any issues?

[end participant screenshare]

Wire Demo [approx 20-30 minutes]

- We now would like to share some design concepts with you and get some feedback on your thoughts. [start our screenshare]

Wire: Add Docket Entry

Scenario: Let's say you want to add an order to a case in a consolidated group and you land on this docket entry page.

- What are your thoughts on the modal that is displayed after clicking on Save and Serve?
- Is it clear to you what the checkbox list is?
- What would you expect to happen if you unchecked the box for "All in the consolidated group"? What about if you checked it?
- Why do you think one of the checkboxes is gray? What do you think it means?
- Have you had scenarios where you created a docket entry for only select cases in a consolidated group? How often does this happen?
- What would you expect to happen if you clicked on "Yes, Serve"?
- Where would you go next? Or would this be your last step in the process?
- What are your thoughts on this alternate version of this list? [show alternate version of checkbox list and get comparative feedback]

Wire: Docket Record - Lead Case

[screenshare mockup labeled "Docket Record - Lead Case"]

Scenario: Let's say you navigate to docket number 195-18 and want to check whether or not it's the lead case.

- With a quick glance, can you tell whether or not this is the lead case? Is this clear to you?
- Current functionality is that the lead case has the lowest docket number - have you ever had a scenario where this was not the case?
- Look at line item 1 - What do you think the text "Copied 01/09/18" in the "Action" column means?
- Does it make sense to have this information listed under the "action" column or is there a more appropriate area given that a user can add free form text in this column when you edit an entry? [show in Dawson if needed]
- What do you expect to happen when you edit the lead case docket entry?
 - Probe: *If they don't mention it being reflected in consolidated cases, probe further*
- Overall, how satisfied are you with this design?

Wire: Docket Record

[screenshare mockup labeled “Docket Record”]

Scenario: As a docket clerk, you would like to learn more information about another case grouped with 195-18, so you navigate to this case and notice there are items listed under the “Action” column. [ignore docket #]

- What do you think “copied from 195-18 09/25/20” means?
- What are your thoughts on how the duplicate document is indicated?
- Is it clear to you that you are seeing a duplicate and not the original document?
- What would you do if you wanted to access the original document?
- What would you expect to happen if you clicked on the hyper-linked number? Would you use it?
- How would you know if this document was associated with the original document?
- How would you dissociate this document with the original document? How often does this happen?

Docket Record - With Modal

[screenshare the modal pop up for “are you sure you want to unlink”]

Scenario: Let’s say you clicked on “unlink” and this modal popped up.

- Is this what you would expect to happen?
- Is the information in the modal clear?
- How would you know the document was successfully unlinked?
- Overall, how satisfied are you with this design?

Conclusion of screenshare session

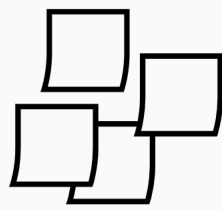
- What do you like the most about the consolidation process? The least?
- If you could have anything you wanted to make consolidation easier, what would you ask for?
- Is there anything else you would like to share?

Synthesis Process

Overview of how we will synthesize interview data

Our team will utilize affinity mapping to synthesize our interview data and research.

- Data and first-hand accounts from interviews will be transformed into stickies in Mural
- All interview data will be anonymized by a unique participant ID
- Similar stickies will be grouped by theme to uncover insights about the user experience
- Human-centered insights will serve as the foundation for opportunities to improve DAWSON



Review and analyze
interview data



Identify patterns and
discover themes



Articulate insights that
point to opportunities

Outcomes

[What will come out of this research](#)

The research gathered from the Docket Clerks will uncover human-centered insights that will serve as the foundation to inform the future design and functionality of DAWSON's consolidation process for online cases.